The Tredecian Calendar

Thirteen months of 28 days. Every month starts on a Sunday and ends on a Saturday.

Year begins Monia 1
(Gregorian March 1)

Monia 1

Aries
Mar 1 to Mar 28

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Bia 2

Taurus
Mar 29 to Apr 25

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Tria 3

Gemini
Apr 26 to May 23

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Tetria 4

Cancer
May 24 to Jun 20

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Pentia 5

Leo
Jun 21 to Jul 18

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Hexia 6

Virgo
Jul 19 to Aug 15

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Heptia 7

Libra
Aug 16 to Sep 12

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Octia 8

Scorpio
Sep 13 to Oct 10

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Nonia 9

Ophiuchus
Oct 11 to Nov 7

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Decia 10

Sagittarius
Nov 8 to Dec 5

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Hendia 11

Capricorn
Dec 6 to Jan 2

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Dodia 12

Aquarius
Jan 3 to Jan 30

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Tridia 13

Pisces
Jan 31 to Feb 27

S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

Outside the weeks

Year Day

After Tridia 28 (Gregorian Feb 28). Belongs to no week.

Leap Day

Every 4 years, after Year Day (Gregorian Feb 29).

Major US holidays

New Year's Day Monia 1, Sun	was Mar 1
Independence Day Pentia 14, Sat	was Jul 4
Halloween Nonia 21, Sat	was Oct 31
Thanksgiving Decia 19, Thu	was 4th Thu of Nov
Christmas Hendia 20, Fri	was Dec 25

AN OVERVIEW

The Tredecian Calendar

Thirteen identical months of 28 days, a year that begins in spring, and month names that finally mean what they say.

What the name means

Tredecian *(treh-DEE-shun)* comes from the Latin *tredecim*, "thirteen," with the ending *-ian*, "of" or "belonging to." It is built the same way as the Julian and Gregorian calendars, and it simply means "the calendar of thirteen." Said aloud, it carries the rhythm of the word *tradition*: a new calendar that sounds like it has always been here.

Where the months get their names

Our current calendar is full of broken numbers. September, October, November and December mean seven, eight, nine and ten, yet they are the 9th through 12th months, because the Romans once started the year in March and the names never caught up. The Tredecian Calendar fixes this with one rule: **each month is its number plus the ending -ia**, using the number roots people already know from math.

1	**Monia** *MO-nee-uh*	mono, one
2	**Bia** *BEE-uh*	bi, two
3	**Tria** *TREE-uh*	tri, three
4	**Tetria** *TET-ree-uh*	tetra, four
5	**Pentia** *PEN-tee-uh*	penta, five
6	**Hexia** *HEX-ee-uh*	hexa, six
7	**Heptia** *HEP-tee-uh*	hepta, seven
8	**Octia** *OCK-tee-uh*	octa, eight
9	**Nonia** *NO-nee-uh*	nona, nine
10	**Decia** *DECK-ee-uh*	deca, ten
11	**Hendia** *HEN-dee-uh*	one and ten
12	**Dodia** *DOE-dee-uh*	two and ten
13	**Tridia** *TRID-ee-uh*	three and ten

The roots are Greek, with two friendly exceptions: *bi* and *non* come from Latin because they are easier to say. In the last three months, the "d" stands for ten, the same way eleven, twelve and thirteen grow out of ten.

Every month is equal

Each month has exactly 28 days: four full weeks, starting on a Sunday and ending on a Saturday. Thirteen of them make 364 days. The last day of the year, **Year Day**, and in leap years **Leap Day**, stand outside the week entirely, so the cycle never slips. The result is a calendar that is the same every single year. The 14th is always a Saturday, every month has the same number of workdays and weekends, and holidays fall on the same weekday forever.

A year that begins in spring

The year opens on Monia 1, our March 1, the same place the ancient Roman year began. Spring arrives within the first month, the year closes at the end of winter, and the extra days sit at the very end of the year, right where the Romans placed theirs. Beginning the count in March is what lets every month name match its number.

In step with the sky

Because the calendar repeats exactly, the turning points of the year settle onto nearly the same dates every year:

Spring equinox	Summer solstice	Autumn equinox	Winter solstice
Monia 20	**Pentia 1**	**Octia 10**	**Hendia 16**

Dates can shift by a day from year to year, as they do today.

The moon. The 7-day week follows the moon's four quarter phases, each about a week long, and a 28-day month is four of those weeks. It also sits close to the 27.3 days the moon takes to circle Earth against the stars. The moon's full cycle of phases is a little longer, about 29.5 days, so full moons drift a day or two earlier each month, much as they drift through our current months.

A zodiac of thirteen

Over a year, the sun passes through thirteen constellations: the twelve familiar zodiac signs plus Ophiuchus *(oh-fee-YOO-kus)*, the serpent bearer, which sits between Scorpio and Sagittarius. The real constellations are uneven, from about a week to over six weeks, so the Tredecian Calendar does what the ancient zodiac did: it divides the sun's yearly path into equal signs. Here there are thirteen, one per month, each about 28 days wide.

Monia **Aries** *AIR-eez*	Bia **Taurus** *TOR-us*	Tria **Gemini** *JEM-ih-nye*	Tetria **Cancer** *KAN-ser*	Pentia **Leo** *LEE-oh*
Hexia **Virgo** *VUR-go*	Heptia **Libra** *LEE-bruh*	Octia **Scorpio** *SKOR-pee-oh*	Nonia **Ophiuchus** *oh-fee-YOO-kus*	Decia **Sagittarius** *saj-ih-TAIR-ee-us*
Hendia **Capricorn** *KAP-rih-korn*	Dodia **Aquarius** *uh-KWAIR-ee-us*	Tridia **Pisces** *PIE-seez*		

Like the traditional zodiac, the signs follow the seasons rather than the drifting stars. The year opens with Aries in the month of the spring equinox and closes with Pisces, so each sign keeps its place in the calendar for good.

Simpler by design

- One month layout to learn, instead of months of 28, 29, 30 and 31 days.
- No more counting knuckles: every month is exactly four weeks.
- Every date keeps its weekday forever, so one printed calendar lasts a lifetime.
- Months compare cleanly, with the same days, workdays and weekends in each.
- Month names tell you their number at a glance.
- Each month carries its own zodiac sign, equal in size and fixed in place.
- Holidays land on the same day every year, and floating ones like Thanksgiving become fixed dates.

Thirteen equal months, thirteen equal signs, a year that starts with spring, and names that count for themselves. The Tredecian Calendar keeps time the way people always wished it would.